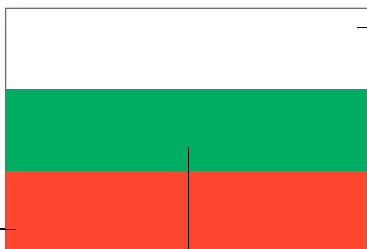


Bulgaria

Ratio: 3:5 **Adopted:** November 22, 1990 **Usage:** National and Civil

Red and white
were taken
from the
pan-Slavic
colors

*Red is for the valor
of the Bulgarian army*



*Before 1990 the
white stripe contained
the Bulgarian coat of
arms*

*The green stripe replaced the
blue of the Russian tricolor*

Europe



Bulgaria became independent in 1908 after 500 years of Ottoman rule. In 1990, the communist regime, in power since 1946, collapsed.

While under Turkish rule, Bulgaria had no national flag. When it became a principality in 1878, a slight variation of the pan-Slavic colors, widely used during the independence movements of the late 19th century, was adopted. The horizontal arrangement of the tricolor was based on the Russian flag at the time, but for Bulgaria's national flag the central blue stripe was substituted by green.

THE PEOPLE'S REPUBLIC

No change was made to the flag during Bulgaria's period as an independent kingdom 1908–1946, but with the formation of the People's Republic in 1947, a coat

of arms was added in the white stripe near the hoist. This depicted a rampant lion, a red star representing communism, and later a cog-wheel symbolizing industrialization. The coat of arms was removed from the flag in 1990 because of its communist connotations. No arms now appear on the flag.

THE SYMBOLISM OF THE COLORS

Although based on the pan-Slavic colors, the white band is said to represent a love of peace, and red, the valor of the people. The green stripe, substituted for the traditional pan-Slavic blue in 1878, was intended to represent the youthfulness of the emerging nation.